Bank Alfalah

ALFA LEAD ASSESSMENT CENTER

Case Study

Solution Key

Part A: Quantitative Solution

Q1: Is the CX investment paying for itself?

Retention improvement: 91% – 82% = 9 percentage points.

Additional customers retained: 4,200,000 × 9% = 378,000 customers per year.

Revenue impact: 378,000 × PKR 4,200 = PKR 1,587,600,000 = approximately PKR 1.59 billion.

CX investment: PKR 320 million.

☑ YES — the investment is paying for itself nearly 5 times over.

ROI: (PKR 1,588M – PKR 320M) / PKR 320M = approximately 396%.

For every PKR 1 spent on customer experience, the bank generates approximately PKR 5 in retained revenue.

This is one of the strongest ROI cases in the bank's portfolio — yet the branch manager's letter suggests the impact goes beyond what the numbers capture.

Q2: Will digital adoption reach 75% by end of 2026?

Current: 67% (Q1 2026). Growth: 3 percentage points per quarter. Quarters remaining: 3 (Q2, Q3, Q4).

Projected: 67% + (3 × 3) = 76%.

☑ YES — the bank will exceed the 75% target, reaching approximately 76% by Q4 2026.

This confirms the branch manager's observation: "80% of my customers used to come for balance checks. Today most do it on the app."

The more interesting question — which the letter raises — is what happens to the branch and its people when digital hits 80% and beyond.

Assessor note: *Both questions produce positive results. The purpose is not to find a problem in the numbers but to use them as a springboard for the deeper discussion the letter invites. Candidates who celebrate the numbers without engaging with the letter's concerns are only seeing half the picture.*

Part B: What Strong Responses Look Like

This case does not ask for a plan. It asks for thinking. There are no "right answers." Assess the depth and honesty of the discussion, not the format of the output.

1. "Technology is an enabler, not a destination"

Strong candidates will recognize that the branch manager is not anti-technology — he's grateful for it. His concern is that the bank has optimized the what (faster complaints, better app, digital transactions) without fully answering the why (what is the branch for now? what are our people supposed to become?).

They might say: "The tools are working, but the organization hasn't caught up. People need to understand their new role, not just use new software."

Weak responses will either dismiss the letter as "resistance to change" or agree vaguely without connecting it to the data.

2. What happens to Hina?

This is the most human question in the case. Strong candidates will recognize that Hina's uncertainty is not a HR problem — it's a strategy problem. If the bank's best young people can't see a future, the talent pipeline from Case Study 3 breaks.

Good answers might include: retraining branch staff as financial advisors rather than transaction processors; creating a career path from teller to relationship manager; or using Hina's language skills and digital comfort to make her the bridge between the app and the customer.

The best answers will connect Hina's story to the branch data: footfall is down 35%, but transaction value per visit is up 60%. The branch is becoming a place for advice, not queues. Hina's role should reflect that shift.

3. Systems that don't talk to each other

The branch manager's observation — complaint data on one screen, product data on another — is a simple but powerful insight about data integration.

Strong candidates will recognize that this is not a technology problem; it's a design choice. The systems were built for departments, not for customers. Connecting them would let the bank see each customer as a whole person, not a collection of separate interactions.

Practical example from the letter: the customer who complained about a late remittance has PKR 2 million in savings. If the branch manager could see both facts on one screen, he could turn a complaint into a relationship conversation. Right now, he can't.

4. What's still missing?

The data shows the bank has the right tools and strong returns. The letter suggests what's missing is the human layer: purpose, career clarity, connected data, and the ability to turn transactions into relationships.

Strong candidates will articulate something like: "The bank has invested in efficiency. It now needs to invest in meaning — for customers and for staff."

Weak responses will suggest more technology, more dashboards, or more KPIs — missing the branch manager's point entirely.

5. One thing for the CEO to focus on

There is no single right answer. What matters is whether the candidate can synthesize the letter, the data, and the discussion into one clear priority. Examples of strong answers:

- "Redefine what a branch is for. The data says transactions are moving to the app. The branch needs to become a place for advice and relationships, and every branch employee needs to know their role in that."
- "Connect the data. The systems work individually but don't talk to each other. One unified customer view would transform how branch staff serve people — and would make the CX investment go even further."
- "Invest in Hina. The next generation of branch staff are digital-native but directionless. Give them a career path that combines technology with human judgment, and the bank's culture transformation will sustain itself."

What to look for: *Can the candidate move from analysis to synthesis? Do they pick one thing and defend it, or do they hedge with "all of the above"? Do they use the letter's language and spirit, or do they revert to corporate strategy jargon?*